NUNO FONTOURA · FREE RESOURCE

PLANNER

The Governance Cadence Planner

A 90-day rhythm you can actually run, not another meeting nobody prepares for.

■ Fillable PDF ■ 4 pages ■ 13-week tracker

WHY A RHYTHM, NOT A FIRE

Operators run rhythms

Founders stuck in firefighting mode fix problems all day, hold everything together, and quietly know they're the constraint.

Operators don't chase every fire, they run rhythms. Daily huddles, weekly reviews and monthly check-ins give the team structure, clarity, and a place to raise issues before they explode. The rhythm only works if it's short, focused and consistent, so it becomes how work happens rather than another meeting on top.

THE THREE LAYERS

15 min

Daily huddle. Same time every day. Owner, today's priorities, what's blocked. Nothing gets solved in the huddle: blockers are named and taken offline.

30–60

Weekly review. Same day every week. Two or three KPIs, what moved and why, and one thing to fix before next week.

60–90

Monthly check-in. Same date every month. Numbers reviewed whether or not anything looks wrong, capacity checked, one process reviewed in depth.

HOW TO USE THIS PLANNER

1. **Set up each layer**: owner, time and standing agenda (page 2).
2. **Run the 13-week tracker**: tick each cycle that actually ran, not just the ones that were scheduled (page 3).
3. **Review at week 13** and decide what to keep, change or drop (page 4).

> **Start with one layer.** The daily huddle is usually the easiest. Add the next layer once the first runs without you chasing it.

BUILD YOUR PLANNER

Set up the three layers

DAILY HUDDLE

15 minutes, same time every day.

TIME

OWNER

STANDING AGENDA

WEEKLY REVIEW

30 to 60 minutes, same day every week.

DAY AND TIME

OWNER

KPIS TRACKED (TWO OR THREE)

MONTHLY CHECK-IN

60 to 90 minutes, same date every month.

DATE EACH MONTH

OWNER

STANDING AGENDA

PLANNER START DATE week 1 begins

13-WEEK TRACKER

Mark what actually ran

Tick the huddle and review only if they ran at least four days and once that week. The monthly check-in is due in weeks 4, 8, 12 and 13.

WEEK	WEEK OF	DAILY HUDDLE RAN	WEEKLY REVIEW RAN	ONE THING FIXED THIS WEEK	MONTHLY CHECK-IN
1		☐	☐		–
2		☐	☐		–
3		☐	☐		–
4		☐	☐		☐
5		☐	☐		–
6		☐	☐		–
7		☐	☐		–
8		☐	☐		☐
9		☐	☐		–
10		☐	☐		–
11		☐	☐		–
12		☐	☐		☐
13		☐	☐		☐

WEEK 13 REVIEW

Keep, change or drop

KEEP

CHANGE

THE BIGGEST THING THE RHYTHM FIXED

THE COMMON FAILURE MODES

Trying to fix everything at once. Install one layer first. Add the next once the first runs without you chasing it.

Keeping exceptions for yourself. If you bypass the rhythm, everyone else will too. The rules apply to you first.

Confusing visibility with micromanagement. The rhythm lets you step back without losing sight, not interfere more often.

> This is a governance cadence in its simplest form, with the first cycle actually run, not just scheduled.

Want to install this properly?

Build your cadence with support: a discovery call shows which areas of your business most need a regular review.

Book a discovery call

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